

KNC 2026 - Observable Behaviors

Plenary Session Overview:

DAY 1

8:00 AM	8:00 AM	0:00:51	VIDEO	VIDEO - Welcome to the 2026 KNC
8:00 AM	8:20 AM	0:20:00	Dalya & Prashanth	Welcome
8:20 AM	8:21 AM	0:01:00	VIDEO	Ayanna Howard intro video
8:21 AM	8:41 AM	0:20:00	Ayanna Howard	Keynote
8:41 AM	8:42 AM	0:01:00	VIDEO	ASEE sizzle intro
8:42 AM	8:48 AM	0:06:00	ASEE (Brian Novoselich) + Doug	ASEE direction + alignment with EM
8:48 AM	8:49 AM	0:01:00	VIDEO	KEEN sizzle
8:49 AM	8:59 AM	0:10:00	EM Behaviors	DeAnna, Kurt, John + Doug as MC
8:59 AM	8:59 AM	0:00:30	SLIDE + AUDIO	Rising Star Intro Graphic with Audio Intro
9:00 AM	9:10 AM	0:10:00	Rising Star Committee	Rising Star Awards
9:11 AM	9:11 AM	0:00:30	—	Transition with Music
9:12 AM	9:15 AM	0:03:00	Dalya & Prashanth	Closing

THEME:

Lead, Design, Inspire - A Hopeful Vision for the Future

Stage direction:

8:48 AM	8:49 AM	0:01:00	VIDEO	KEEN sizzle
8:49 AM	8:59 AM	0:10:00	EM Behaviors	DeAnna, Kurt, John + Doug as MC

KEEN sizzle video narrative: “There is so much going on in KEEN! Across campuses nationwide, faculty are collaborating to empower learners to tackle real-world challenges, innovate boldly, and imagine what’s possible. Together we’re on a mission to equip the rising generation with an entrepreneurial mindset— empowering engineers to build solutions that contribute to human flourishing and transform the world. Please welcome to the stage Doug Melton to share some of the highlights from the Network.”

Kurt, DeAnna, John and Doug are off-stage.

Doug is waiting for the KEEN “sizzle video”, entering approximately during the final 15-20 seconds of the video.

Kurt, DeAnna, or John have a slide clicker.

Kurt, DeAnna, and John remain off-stage for a moment, waiting for the invitation to join.

→ **See script below.**

All exit to backstage after framing and introduction and exchange

Script:

[0:00]

Doug: (*Doug does not have slides for this first part*)

When you're describing entrepreneurial mindset and KEEN to others, what are your go-to resources?

Maybe you start with the KEEN Framework—our shared touchstone.

Or you reach for the Habits of Entrepreneurial Mindset, because the language connects instantly and gives people something concrete to hold onto.

Those documents? They help us explain *what* entrepreneurial mindset is.

But then comes the question we *always* hear:

"Okay — let's talk about the 'how' — what does that actually *look like* in practice?"

[pause]

Now, as a community, we've made real progress on assessment. Efforts like COMPASS and others have helped us surface and refine a wide range of tools. Engineering Unleashed currently points to over a hundred instruments for measuring entrepreneurial mindset.

126 to be exact..

That's a strength—but it creates a challenge: How do we make sense of all that work? How do we connect it to what we actually *see* students doing?

Three members of our community have been working on exactly that question through their work — much of it talking with you!

John Estell, DeAnna Leitzke, and Kurt Paterson aren't replacing existing tools. They're building a bridge—connecting our shared language about entrepreneurial mindset to observable student behavior.

Please join me in welcoming them to the stage.

All enter the stage.

[2:00-9:30]

Kurt: *(Slides - Observable behaviors - provided by Kurt, DeAnna, John)*

DeAnna:

John:

... add here ...

[9:30]

Doug: *(One slide: framework → engagement, implementation, assessment, scholarship)*

Over the years, many of us have informally created what you might call a KEEN starter kit — a small set of materials we reach for when we want to engage others, implement EM in courses or programs, assess student development, or contribute to the scholarship around entrepreneurial mindset.

At the top of that kit sits the KEEN Framework. It gives us coherence — a shared view of what we mean by entrepreneurial mindset and why it matters.

From there, we tend to pull different resources depending on our purpose.

Some help with **engagement**—inviting faculty or students into the conversation.

Others support **implementation**—what to design, what to try, how to scaffold experiences. Some focus on **assessment**, and others help us situate our work within **scholarship**.

The Observable Behaviors adds an important piece to that starter kit. It strengthens the connective tissue — linking shared language about EM to observable, discussable behaviors, all while staying anchored to the Framework.

[10:00]